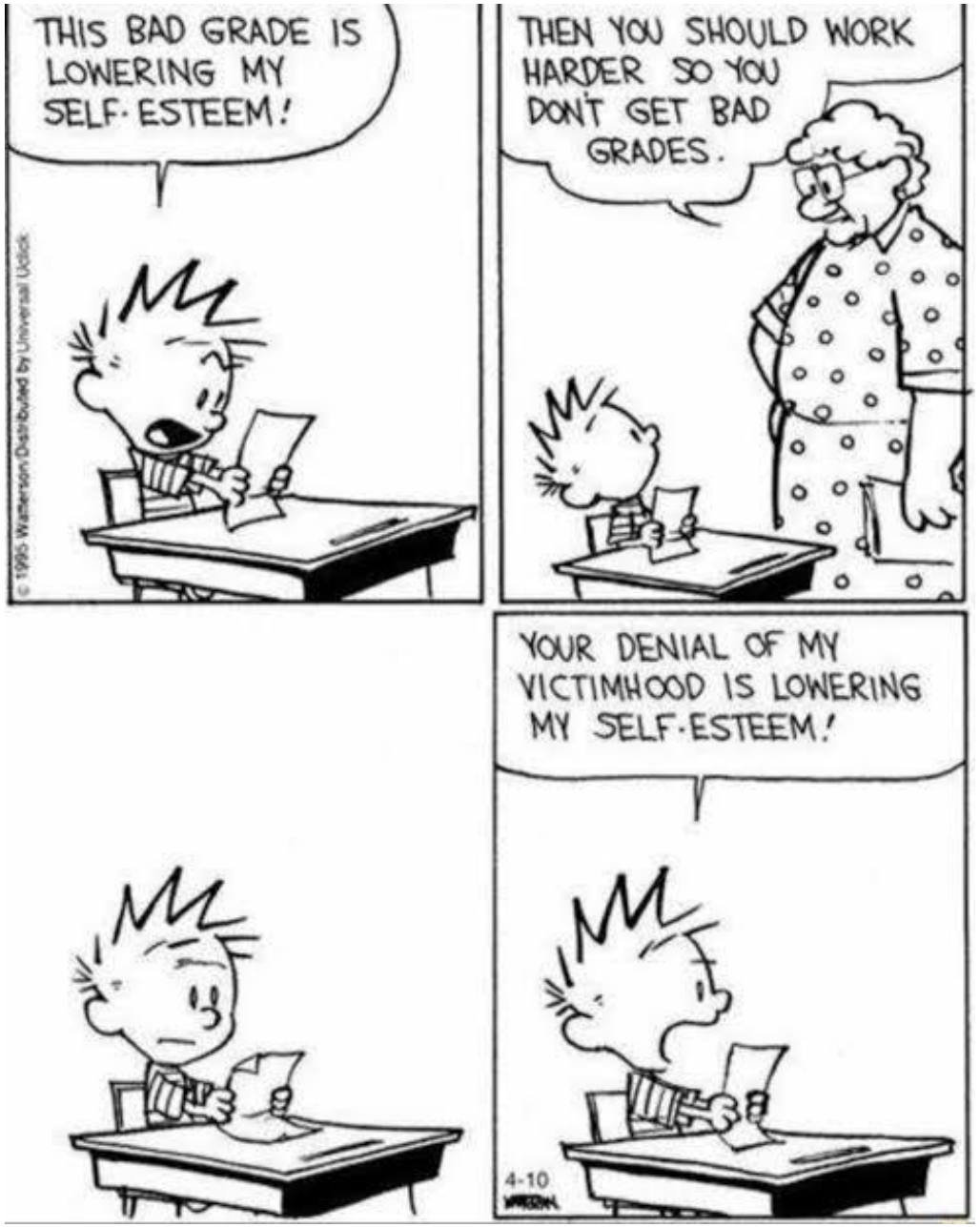
COLLECTIVE SELF-ESTEEM & SELF-AFFIRMATION

The Self & Social Identities



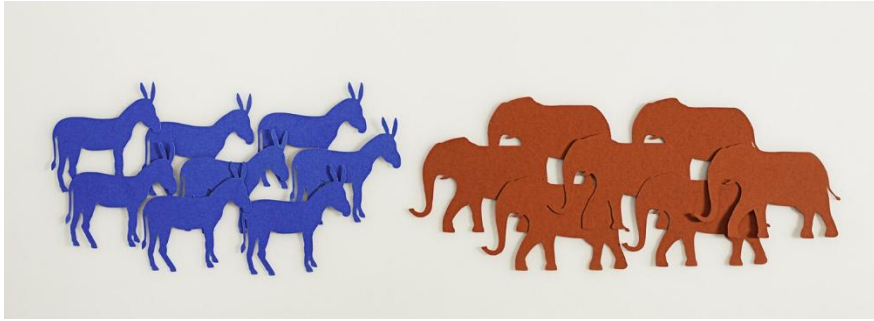
PERSONAL IDENTITY

- **Beliefs about one's skills, abilities, or attributes such as attractiveness or intelligence**



COLLECTIVE IDENTITY

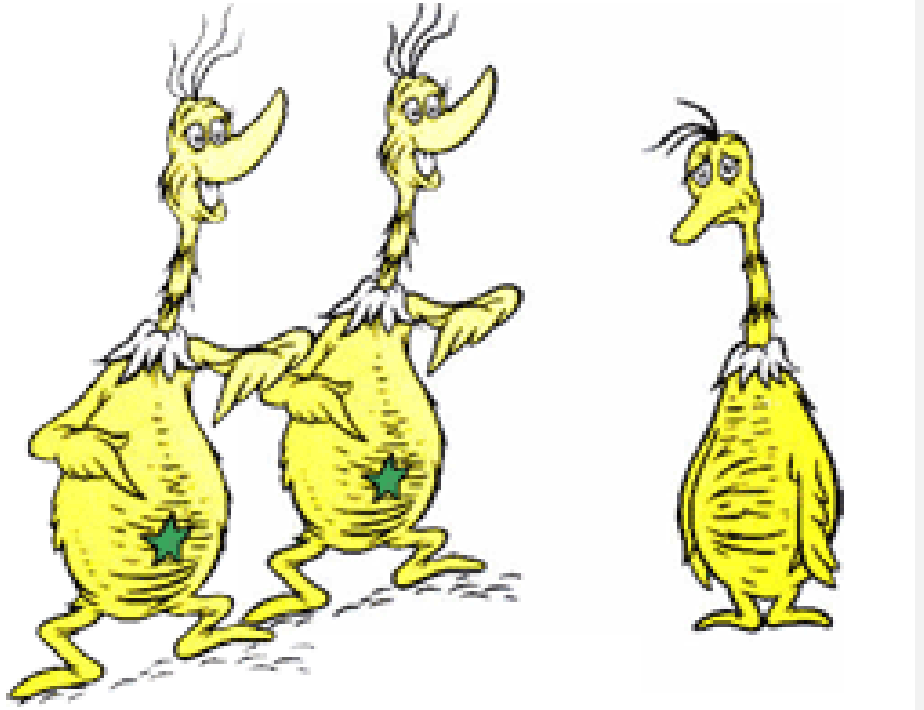
"that aspect of the individuals' self-concept which derives from their knowledge of their membership in a social group (or groups) together with the value/significance attached to that membership"
(Tajfel, 1981, p. 255)



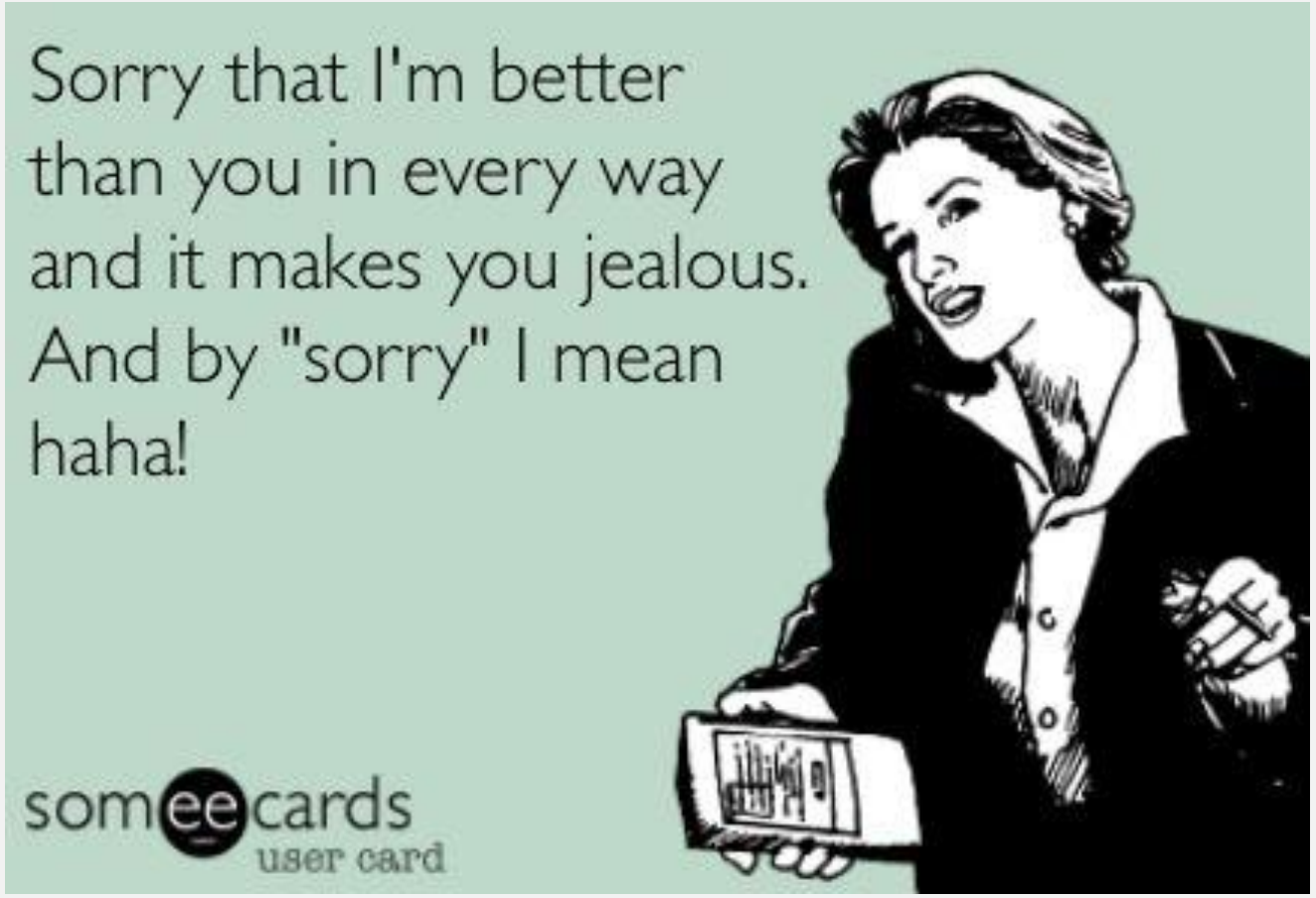
POSITIVE SELF/GROUP EVALUATION

People will always evaluate ingroup members more favorably than outgroup members

Even under minimal conditions, and in the absence of any history or conflict between groups, people show bias in favor of the ingroup



POSITIVE SELF/GROUP EVALUATION



- **How does this relate to SIT?**

- **Social identity theory provides a compelling account of discrimination against outgroups by linking such behavior to the maintenance of a positive self-concept, specifically a positive social identity**

WHAT'S YOUR COLLECTIVE SELF ESTEEM?

1 (strongly disagree) to 7 (strongly agree)

1. I am a worthy member of the social groups I belong to.
2. I often regret that I belong to some of the social groups I do.
3. Overall, my social groups are considered good by others.
4. Overall, my group memberships have very little to do with how I feel about myself.
5. I feel I don't have much to offer to the social groups I belong to.
6. In general, I'm glad to be a member of the social groups I belong to.
7. Most people consider my social groups, on the average, to be more ineffective than other social groups.
8. The social groups I belong to are an important reflection of who I am.

WHAT'S YOUR COLLECTIVE SELF ESTEEM?

1 (strongly disagree) to 7 (strongly agree)

9. I am a cooperative participant in the social groups I belong to.
10. I often feel that my social groups are not worthwhile.
11. In general, others respect the social groups that I am a member of.
12. The social groups I belong to are unimportant to my sense of what kind of a person I am.
13. I often feel I'm a useless member of my social groups.
14. I feel good about the social groups I belong to.
15. Others think that the social groups I am a member of are unworthy.
16. In general, belonging to social groups is an important part of my self image.

SCORING YOUR COLLECTIVE SELF ESTEEM

- **Scoring Instructions**
- **First, reverse-score (8 - score) items 2, 4, 5, 7, 10, 12, 13, and 15: such that (1 = 7), (2 = 6), (3 = 5), (4 = 4), (5 = 3), (6 = 2), (7 = 1)**

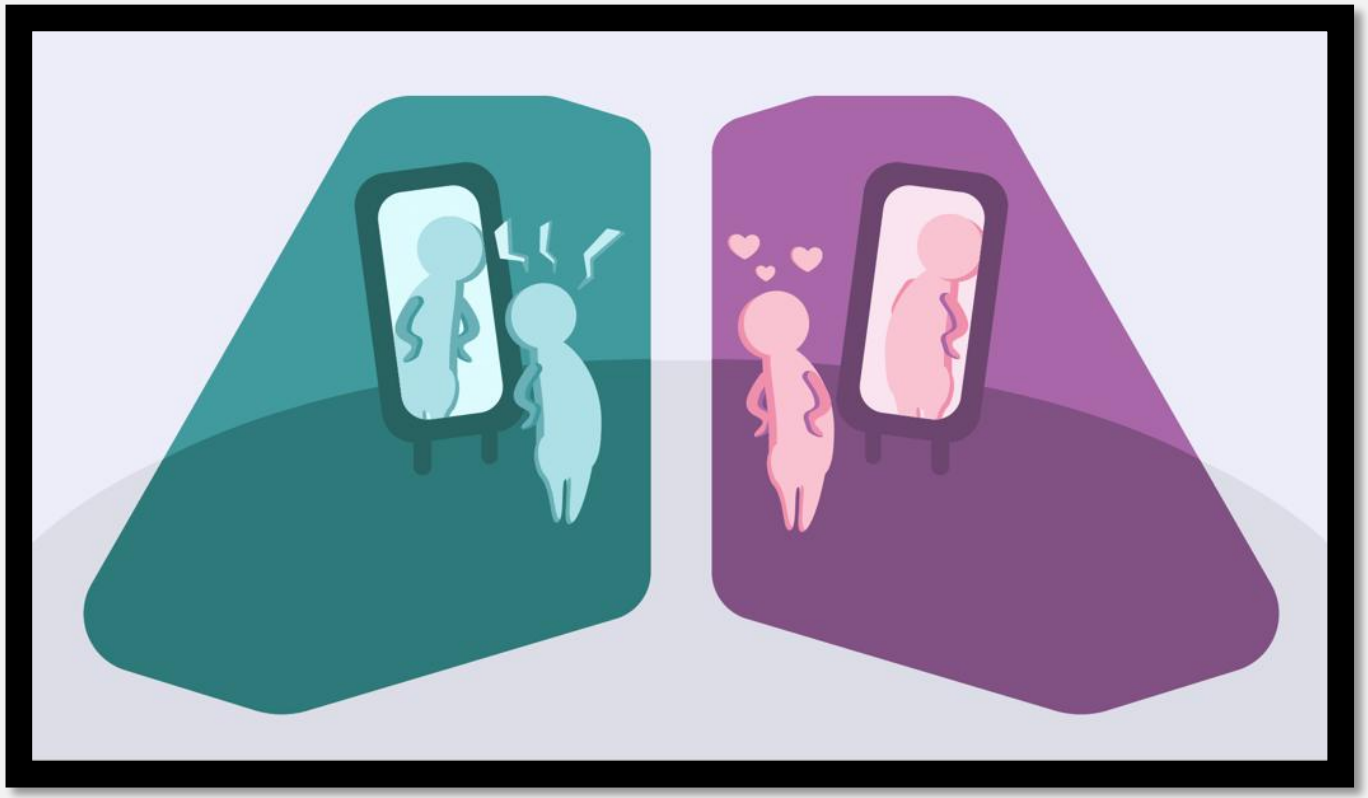
- **The four subscales are as follows:**
- **Items 1, 5, 9 and 13 = Membership self-esteem**
- **Items 2, 6, 10 and 14 = Private collective self-esteem**
- **Items 3, 7, 11, and 15 = Public collective self-esteem**
- **Items 4, 8, 12, and 16 = Importance to Identity**

(max score is 28)

DISCUSSION

- **How does identity activation maybe influence your responses?**

- **What group memberships did you have in mind? How meaningful were they?**



CROCKER & LUHTANEN (1990)

•People differ in how positively they feel about the groups they belong to

•Big question: **When your group does poorly, does how you feel about that group shape your reaction?**

•Study: Told high/low self esteem participants their group had succeeded or failed and examined how they responded



CROCKER & LUHTANEN (1990)

- People high in **collective self-esteem** boosted their group's image
  - When their group succeeded: They rated strong in-group members more positively
- When their group failed: They rated those same members less positively
- People low in collective self-esteem: Did **not** change their ratings based on whether the group won or lost



Stress Appraisal Theory

Lazarus & Folkman

Our interpretation (appraisal) of an event influences how stressful it feels and how we respond.

Threat Appraisal

"This is harmful to me."



Emotional Response

Anxiety · Hopelessness

Outcome

More stress, avoidance, lower motivation, poorer performance

THE SAME EVENT



You get a low exam grade

Appraisal Process

1. Is this event relevant to me?
2. Is it harmful, neutral, or beneficial?
3. Do I have the resources to cope? (Support, skills, time, etc.)

Challenge Appraisal

"I can manage this."



Emotional Response

Determination · Confidence · Calm

Outcome

Less stress, problem-solving, higher motivation, better performance

Self-Affirmation Theory



Thinking about what you value helps protect
your self-esteem when facing stress or setbacks.
It reminds you that you are more than one difficult moment.



SEIDMAN, FACEBOOK IDENTITY

- What is the relationship between the Big 5 Personality traits and Facebook behavior?

- The need to belong is a major motivator of Facebook (and other social media):
  - Social connectedness, acceptance, positive affect, self-esteem…and self presentation



THE BIG 5 TRAITS

- **Extraversion** is characterized by sociability, energy, and talkativeness
- **Agreeableness** involves warmth, cooperativeness, and helpfulness
- **Openness** consists of creativity, intellectualism, and preference for novelty
- **Conscientiousness** is reflected in discipline, responsibility, and orderliness
- **Neuroticism** is characterized by anxiety, moodiness, and emotional instability

METHODS

- **184 undergrads surveyed about their personality traits and their Facebook use**



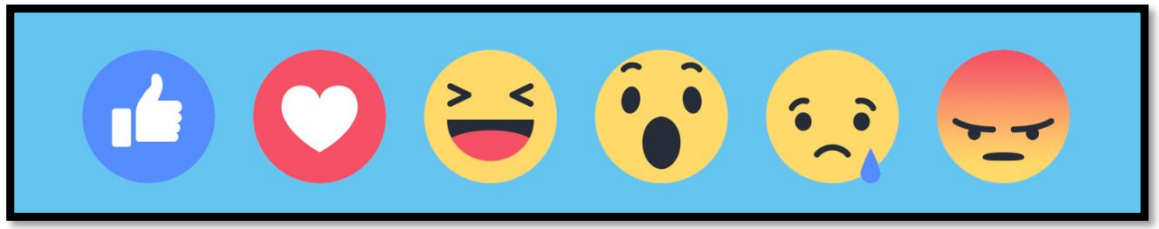
  - **How did they measure belongingness?**
    - **Information-seeking:** viewing others' profiles, viewing others' photographs, etc.
    - **Communication:** commenting on others' posts
    - **Acceptance-seeking:** posting to feel included and posting to make others feel closer to oneself
    - **Connection/caring:** posting to feel closer to others, show caring for others, and support others

METHODS

- **How did they measure self-presentation?**
  - ***General self-disclosure:*** *changing status, updating profile, posting about special events*
  - ***Emotional disclosure:*** *posting about "drama in my life" and venting*
  - ***Attention-seeking:*** *showing off and getting attention*
  - ***Ratings of their actual self, their hidden self, and their ideal self***



RESULTS?



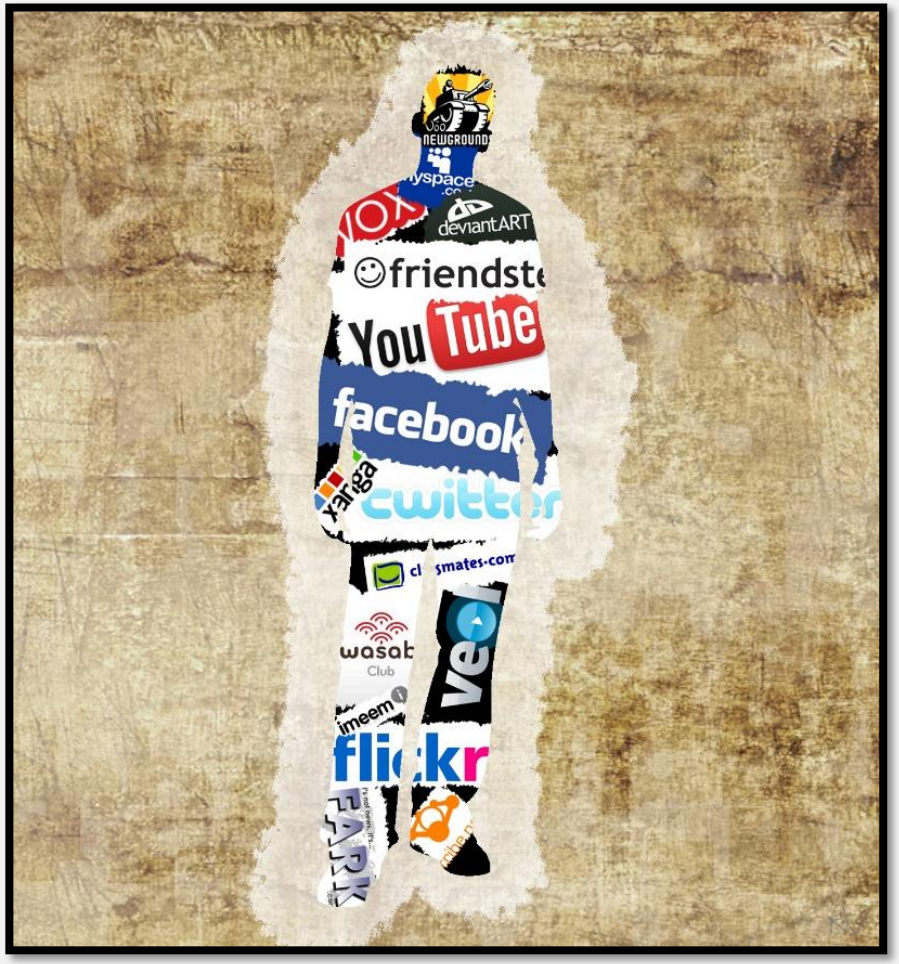
- People who are more agreeable or more neurotic were most likely to use Facebook to feel connected and accepted. Facebook can help meet these social needs.

- People who were more neurotic and less conscientious were more likely to focus on how they presented themselves online. Conscientious people tend to be careful about what they share online.

- People high in neuroticism may see Facebook as a safe place to express themselves.

WHAT ABOUT YOUR SOCIAL MEDIA USE?

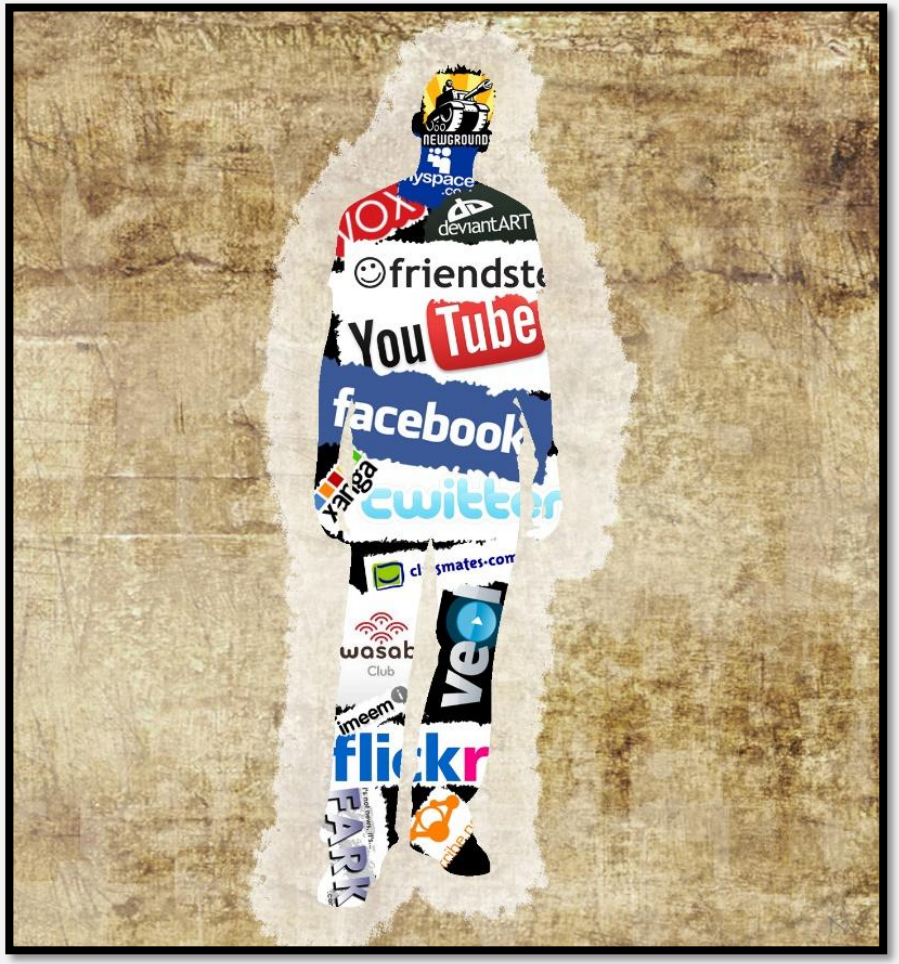
- How do you view your own behavior on Facebook, IG, Snap Chat, TikTok, Twitter, etc.?
- Do some of these platforms fulfill a need to belong more than others?



WHAT ABOUT YOUR SOCIAL MEDIA USE?

- Do you think Facebook/social media is beneficial or detrimental to social belonging? To your own social identity?

- What about AI use? How does it fit?



NEXT CLASS….

Cultural Identities with Dr. Cristina Salvador!

Paper 1 Outline Thursday by 9am!!